The UK Business Year Quiz 2025/26

Thirty questions on the year UK business just had — the cyber attack that cost M&S an estimated £300 million, the chain sold for £1, the sausage roll empire that hit 2,700 shops, and the brands that didn't make it.

What's inside
Round 1 — The Numbers: closest guess wins.
Round 2 — Winners and Losers: who had a good year, who didn't.
Round 3 — Name the Company: the story is real, the name is missing.
Round 4 — True or False: half of these sound made up. They aren't all.
Round 5 — Think Like an Examiner: match the story to the business concept.
Full answer key with a one-line debrief for every question.

For end-of-term lessons, GCSE and A-Level Business, tutor time or open evenings. Teams of 3-4, 45-60 minutes, no projector needed - print and go. Every fact from company results and reported news, 2025 to June 2026.

Free resource from thebusiness.school

How to run it

Teams of 3-4. Hand each team an answer grid (or scrap paper). Read questions aloud or print the round pages. Rounds 1-4 are one point each. Round 5 is two points each because it asks for reasoning, not recall. Maximum score: 36.

Round 1 scoring (closest guess): the team nearest the real number takes the point - no need to be exact. This keeps weaker teams in the game and produces the best arguments.

Why a quiz is worth a lesson

Application is the mark students drop most. The fix is knowing real businesses - what happened, the numbers, what the company did next. Every question here doubles as an application example they can quote in an exam answer next year. The answer key gives you a one-line debrief per question so the quiz teaches on the way through, not just at the end.

Timing that works: 5 min setup - 30 min for five rounds - 10 min marking and debrief, reading the debrief lines out as you go. The arguments about Round 1 guesses are the lesson. Let them run.

Round 1 — The Numbers

Closest guess takes the point. No phones.

1	M&S was hit by a major cyber attack in April 2025 and could not take online clothing orders for 46 days. Roughly how much did M&S say the attack would cost in operating profit? (in £ millions)
2	How many shops did Greggs reach during 2025?
3	Poundland was sold in June 2025. What was the price paid for the whole chain?
4	From April 2026, what is the National Living Wage per hour for workers aged 21 and over?
5	What share of the British grocery market does Tesco hold in 2026, according to Kantar? (in %)
6	Roughly how many chain store closures were recorded across the UK in 2025?

Round 2 — Winners and Losers

For each business: did it have a GOOD year or a BAD year in 2025/26? One point per correct call.

7	Greggs - think shop numbers, revenue, and what happened after 5pm.
8	Claire's - the accessories chain found in almost every shopping centre.
9	Aldi and Lidl combined - the German discounters' share of British groceries.
10	Bodycare - the high street health and beauty discounter.
11	Deliveroo - the food delivery firm with the teal jackets. (Like Q12: argue it either way for the point.)
12	M&S - despite everything in Round 1, how did the year end up? (Trick question - argue it either way for the point.)

Round 3 — Name the Company

The story is real. Name the business.

13	Its UK restaurant operator went into administration in October 2025. The American parent company stepped in with a rescue deal that saved 64 sites and around 1,276 jobs. Stuffed crust was not harmed.
14	A shoe retailer founded in 1879 collapsed into administration - and was bought by Next, which kept just three of its 35 stores.
15	This telecoms merger, worth £16.5 billion, created the UK's biggest mobile network when two rivals combined.
16	During its cyber crisis this retailer's stock systems went down, so staff tracked fresh food deliveries with pen and paper.
17	An online fashion retailer that reported an operating loss of over £300m relaunched a famous high-street brand it had bought out of administration - betting on brand strength instead of price cuts.
18	This DIY chain fell into administration in late 2024 and closed 65 stores in the first three months of 2025.

Round 4 — True or False

One point each. Confidence is not evidence.

19	True or false: around 2,000 Greggs shops now stay open beyond 5pm, and Greggs ranks in the UK's top five for dinner visits.
20	True or false: Deliveroo was bought by the Dutch delivery firm Just Eat in 2025.
21	True or false: Aldi and Lidl together now hold a bigger share of British groceries than Sainsbury's.
22	True or false: the group blamed for the M&S attack is known as 'Scattered Spider'.
23	True or false: after Claire's UK stores closed, a French entrepreneur announced plans to reopen around 50 of them in June 2026.
24	True or false: the National Living Wage fell slightly in April 2026 to help small businesses with costs.

Round 5 — Think Like an Examiner

Two points each: one for the answer, one for the reasoning. These are the application examples your class can reuse in real exam answers next year.

25	Greggs opened an average of four new shops a week in 2025, yet says evening trading is its fastest-growing opportunity. Which grows revenue WITHOUT adding new sites - and what do business students call using existing assets more fully?
26	M&S lost around £300m of profit from one cyber attack. Name the type of planning businesses do so that one event can't stop operations - and one thing M&S did that showed it in action.
27	Poundland sold for £1 - yet the buyer still wanted it. What does a £1 price tag tell you about the difference between a firm's revenue and its value?
28	Aldi and Lidl have grown from about 10% of the grocery market in 2017 to 18.3% now. Which pricing strategy built that - and name one way the big four supermarkets have fought back.
29	Yum! Brands rescued Pizza Hut UK through a 'pre-pack administration'. Why might saving 64 sites and 1,276 jobs still be controversial for the people the old company owed money to?
30	The National Living Wage rose to £12.71 in April 2026. Name one business in this quiz you'd expect to feel it most, and why labour-intensive firms are hit hardest.

Answer key + debrief lines

Round 1 — The Numbers

Q	Answer	One line for the debrief
1	Around £300 million	One ransomware attack, 46 days without online clothing orders, pen-and-paper stockkeeping. Cyber risk is now a board-level cost, not an IT detail.
2	2,700 shops	Milestone hit in 2025 - roughly four new shops opened every week. Revenue about £2.08bn, up 8% on the year.
3	£1	Yes, one pound. The buyer takes on the debts and the turnaround risk - the price reflects liabilities, not the brand's fame.
4	£12.71 per hour	Up from £12.21 in April 2025. Multiply the extra 50p by thousands of staff hours to see why retailers mention it in every results statement.
5	27.3%	Britain's biggest grocer by far - Sainsbury's is next at 15.1% (Kantar, 2026). Clubcard pricing is a big part of how it defends that lead.
6	More than 13,000	Chain store closures recorded across 2025 - the long contraction of physical retail in one number.

Round 2 — Winners and Losers

Q	Answer	One line for the debrief
7	GOOD year	2,700 shops, revenue up 8%, evening sales the fastest-growing part of the business.
8	BAD year	Administration in August 2025; UK standalone stores gone by April 2026.
9	GOOD year	Combined share 18.3% and still outgrowing the market - up from about 10% in 2017.
10	BAD year	All of its roughly 150 stores closed in 2025.
11	Either - argue it	Taken over by US firm DoorDash in late 2025. Shareholders got paid; the independent UK company disappeared. Good year or bad depends on whose side you count.
12	Either - argue it	Lost ~£300m to the attack but recovered operations by summer and kept customer trust. Resilience can be a better story than a quiet year.

Round 3 — Name the Company

Q	Answer	One line for the debrief
13	Pizza Hut (UK)	Operator DC London Pie failed; parent Yum! Brands bought the UK business back through a pre-pack deal.
14	Russell & Bromley	146 years old. Next kept Chelsea, Mayfair and Bluewater - around 440 jobs were put at risk.
15	Vodafone + Three	£16.5bn merger - a competition-policy debate in one deal: fewer networks, but more investment promised.
16	M&S	The most analogue possible fix for the most digital possible problem.
17	ASOS	Relaunched Topshop in 2024 after years of losses - a brand-led recovery instead of a price war.
18	Homebase	65 stores closed January-March 2025 after its late-2024 administration.

Round 4 — True or False

Q	Answer	One line for the debrief
19	TRUE	About 2,000 shops open past 5pm; Greggs ranks fourth in the market for dinner visits. Same ovens, more selling hours.
20	FALSE	It was DoorDash - the American delivery firm - and the deal completed in late 2025.
21	TRUE	18.3% combined vs Sainsbury's 15.1% (Kantar 2026). The 'big four' label is overdue an edit.
22	TRUE	The name is real. So was the pen-and-paper stock tracking.
23	TRUE	Around 50 UK stores planned to reopen from June 2026 under new ownership.
24	FALSE	It rose to £12.71. The NLW has never been cut.

Round 5 — Think Like an Examiner (2 points: answer + reasoning)

Q	Answer	One line for the debrief
25	Evening trading; capacity utilisation	Longer hours sweat assets the firm already pays rent on. New shops grow capacity; evenings grow utilisation.
26	Contingency planning (risk management)	Pen-and-paper stock tracking kept fresh food moving while systems were down - an unglamorous plan that worked.
27	Value reflects future profits and debts, not sales	A chain can ring up millions in revenue and still be worth £1 if liabilities and losses swallow it.
28	Cost leadership / low-price strategy; big four fought back with loyalty pricing	Tesco's Clubcard Prices offers members 10-20% off thousands of lines - matching the discounters without rebuilding the whole price file.
29	Creditors often lose out in a pre-pack	The business survives and jobs are saved, but old debts can be left behind in the failed company - suppliers may never be paid in full.
30	Greggs / any big retailer; wages are their biggest controllable cost	In labour-intensive firms, pay is a huge share of total cost - a 50p rise lands on every staffed hour of every shop.

Liked making them argue about business?

The Business School is a browser-based business simulation where students stop quizzing about other people's companies and run their own - in teams, setting prices, taking loans, hiring staff, filing VAT and negotiating deals, in one 60-minute session. Students join with a PIN; no accounts, no installs. You get a live teacher dashboard and automatic grading.

Sources: company results statements and reported figures 2025-26 - Greggs plc 2025 preliminary results (revenue ~£2.08bn, 2,700 shops, evening trading 9.4% of company-managed shop sales); M&S statements on the April 2025 cyber incident (~£300m estimated profit impact); Kantar grocery market share data 2026 (Tesco 27.3%, Sainsbury's 15.1%, Aldi 10.2%, Lidl 8.1%); reported administrations and deals 2025-26 (Claire's, Bodycare, Homebase, Russell & Bromley/Next, DC London Pie/Yum! Brands, Poundland, Deliveroo/DoorDash, Vodafone-Three); UK Government National Living Wage rates 2025 and 2026; Centre for Retail Research closure data 2025.